

Hard Days For The Knight

Fight the Dark Side of the force as a Jedi Knight or join them in this latest Star Wars Role Playing Game. May the force be with you!!

If you aren't a die hard 'Knights of the Old Republic' fan, and if you don't know your Star Wars from your Star Trek, then KOTOR 2: The Sith Lords is not a sequel you would appreciate. However, for those of us who feel the force, the latest RPG from the Lucas Arts stable, this is a fitting sequel to its predecessor which in 2003 was awarded 'Game of the Year.'

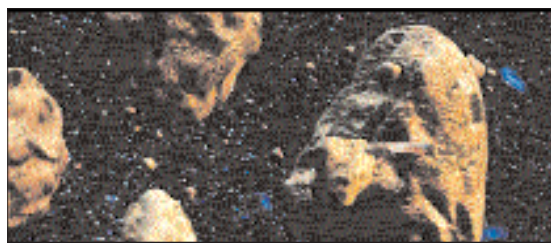
The Prologue

Five years after the events that occurred in Knights of the Old Republic, the Sith Lords have hunted the Jedi to the edge of extinction and are on the verge of crushing the Old Republic. With all hope lost and the Jedi Order in ruins, the Republic's only hope is a Jedi Knight suffering from amnesia and struggling to reconnect with the Force. As with all the galaxy's heroes the Jedi is faced with the most dire decision in the galaxy, whether to follow the path of the light or to succumb to the dark side.

The Gameplay

The story begins on a freighter heading into an asteroid belt. The character you've chosen lies unconscious in its medical bay. Your first task is to guide a T3 droid around the ship and ensure a safe landing on the closest planet. After regaining consciousness your character goes through a process of self discovery and learning about his or her past. All this while combating sabotaged maintenance droids and other vile creatures.

With characters from KOTOR popping up for a visit it gives you a sense of being part of a long saga. The user interface and the look of the game too are reminiscent of the predecessor, however the story grips you and keeps you engaged in the gameplay and doesn't give you an overwhelming sense of déjà vu. Also present is the original game's deep system of ethics. The missions that you choose to perform, the people that you work with, even the things that you say in casual conversation all can have effects on your force alignment. This intricate conversation system is one of KOTOR 2's biggest plus points. Essentially, if you do bad things or are rude in your conversations then you will lean towards the dark side of the Force. However, in practice, things get a little more complicated than this. Sometimes, doing the right thing the wrong way, or doing something that looks like the right



Heading into the asteroid belt, Watch out for the rocks



Fighting the sabotaged droids

thing, but really isn't, can earn you some dark points. In this game, there is also such thing as a gray area and the player must try to navigate this in order to keep from earning points that would jeopardise your choice of alignment. Your actions also influence the personalities of your fellow party members, these are your allies or teammates and characters you can play. The more you lean towards the dark side the more corrupt your team mates get.

Tech Specs

Technically the game is not too demanding and would work fine on an averagely configured computer. That has a flipside of course and that's the lack of zing in the graphics department. Tested on a PC that just made the cut, the game ran perfectly well and did so again when tested on a high end machine with 2.4 GHz processor, 1GB RAM and a 256 MB graphics card. On occasions you could see the character type out commands on non-existent keyboards.

One of the biggest pluses though was the sound and the music. The sound effects are crisp and very clear, and the voice acting is done very well. With a unique dialogue set and a great background score the game has one of the best sound among the RPGs.

The Final Word

Though the game takes the galactic saga forward it doesn't quite bring in any new twists to the Revan-Malak storyline. This game as a stand alone RPG is as good as any around today, but the expectations were sky high after KOTOR. If RPG is your cup of tea the KOTOR 2 is a must play more so if you think you are a Jedi reborn. We would give it an 8/10. ☒

Publisher: Obsidian Entertainment

Software Requirements: Windows 98 SE, 2000 and XP

Minimum System Configuration: Pentium III or Athlon 1 GHz, 256 MB RAM, 32 MB OpenGL Graphics Card, DirectX 9.0c compatible

Price: Rs 1,299

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